

Challenge Write-Up Template

Challenge Information

Student Name	Daniella Marie A. Leonud
Section / Class	BSIT-3G
Challenge Name	Printer Shares
Category	General Skills
Points / Difficulty	Easy
Date Solved	August 9, 2026
Flag Format Given	picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_51f37693}

1. Challenge Description

Restate the challenge in your own words: what were you given, and what were you asked to find or do? Do not simply copy-paste the original prompt.

In this Printer Shares challenge, an important file was accidentally sent to a network printer host. My goal was to inspect the print server, connect to it using the SMB protocol, and recover the file containing the flag. The challenge gave me access to a remote server and hinted that understanding SMB would be helpful. My goal was to find the available shared folders, access the correct share, and locate the file containing the flag.

2. Initial Analysis / Reconnaissance

What did you check first? What did file, strings, a webpage view-source, or another first look tell you? What category did you decide this was, and why?

First, I opened and read the challenge description and the given hints. After launching the challenge instance, I was given the following command **nc -vz mysterious-sea.picoctf.net 52805**. The challenge hint mentioned that understanding the **SMB protocol** would be helpful. This made me focus on finding SMB shares available on the remote server. Instead of trying to access the server randomly, I decided to use smbclient, which is a command-line tool that allows me to interact with SMB shares. From the information given by the challenge, I also noticed that the server could be accessed as a guest user without providing a password. This suggested that I should try listing the available SMB shares using guest access.

Printer Shares

General Skills Easy

by Janice He · picoCTF 2026

Oops! Someone accidentally sent an important file to a network printer—can you retrieve it from the print server?

The printer is on 52805.

you can try `$ nc -vz mysterious-sea.picoctf.net 52805`

INSTANCE ⓘ

Expires in 14:54 Restart Instance

HINTS ⓘ

1 knowing how SMB protocol works would be helpful!

Bookmark

8,039 97%

Open in Workspace

3. Tools and Commands Used

List every tool/command you used, in the order you used them, and what each one told you.

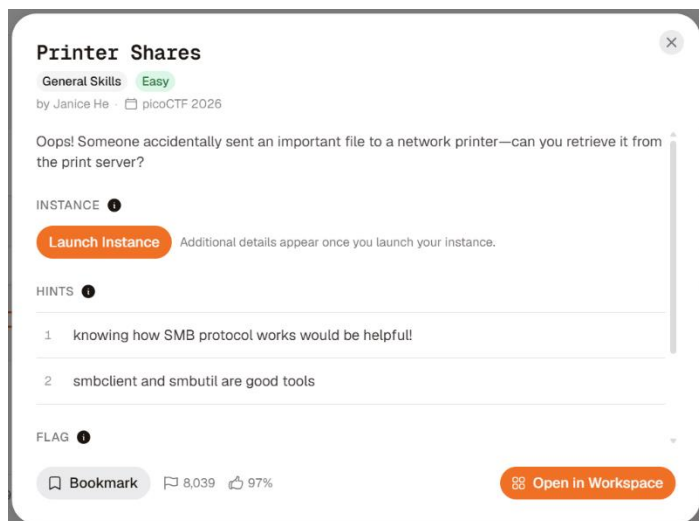
Tool / Command	What it was used for	Result / Output
<code>smbclient -L mysterious-sea.picoctf.net -p 52805 -U guest -N</code>	Listed available SMB shares on the target server as a guest.	Identified the public shares
<code>smbclient //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net/shares -p 52805 -U guest -N</code>	Connected interactively to the shares SMB directory.	Opened an interactive smb: \> shell.
<code>ls</code>	Listed files inside the shares directory.	Found dummy.txt and flag.txt.
<code>get flag.txt</code>	Downloaded flag.txt to the local workspace.	File saved to local directory
<code>cat flag.txt</code>	Displayed the contents of flag.txt	Outputted the flag.

4. Solution Walkthrough

Explain your reasoning step by step — not just what you typed, but why you tried it and what you concluded from the result. Include screenshots, code snippets, or command output where useful. A reader who has not seen the challenge should be able to follow your logic and arrive at the same answer.

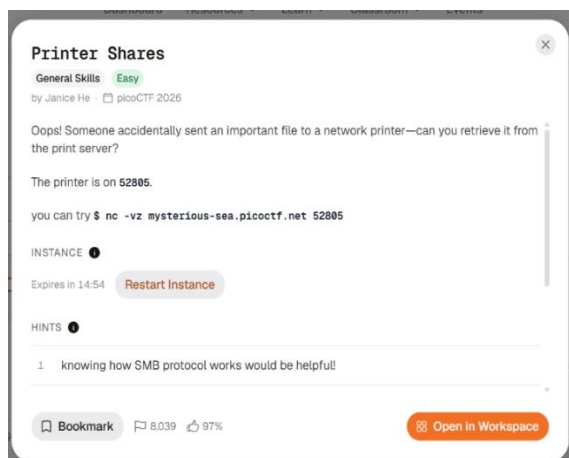
Step 1

First, I opened the Printer Shares challenge and read the challenge description and the given hints. The hint mentioned the SMB protocol, so I knew that the challenge involved accessing a network share rather than simply searching through the local files.



Step 2

After reading and understanding the challenge, I launched the instance and opened the workspace. The challenge provided a remote server and port. I then proceeded to the terminal so I could interact with the server and investigate the available SMB shares.



Step 3

Since the challenge is about SMB, I ran **smbclient -L mysterious-sea.picoctf.net -p 52805 -U guest -N** to inspect the server's shared folders. The output revealed that a disk share called **shares** with guest access. Then I used **smbclient //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net/shares -p 52805 -U guest -N** to connect on the shared SMB directory. The **-L** option was used to list the available SMB shares. The **-p 52805** is the specified port. The **-U guest** specified that I wanted to connect using the guest account, while **-N** told the command not to ask for a password. The output revealed a disk share called **shares**. This was important because it showed me that there was a publicly accessible SMB share that I could investigate.

Once I was inside the SMB shell, I used **ls** to list the files in the shared directory. The output showed two files **dummy.txt** and **flag.txt**. Since it was obvious where the flag is, I chose the flag.txt.

```
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ smbclient -L mysterious-sea.picoctf.net -p 52805 -U guest -N
Sharename      Type      Comment
-----
shares         Disk      Public Share With Guests
IPC$           IPC       IPC Service (Samba 4.19.5-Ubuntu)
SMB1 disabled -- no workgroup available
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ smbclient //mysterious-sea.picoctf.net/shares -p 52805 -U guest -N
Try "help" to get a list of possible commands.
smb: \> ls
.                D           0   Fri Mar 6 20:25:44 2026
..               D           0   Fri Mar 6 20:25:44 2026
dummy.txt        N          1142 Wed Feb 4 21:22:17 2026
flag.txt         N           37   Fri Mar 6 20:25:44 2026

65536 blocks of size 1024. 58232 blocks available
```

Step 4

I downloaded the file from SMB share using **get flag.txt**. After running the command, flag.txt was successfully saved locally. Then I exited the SMB shell using **exit**. This returned me to the normal terminal. After downloading the file, I used **cat flag.txt** to display its contents.

```
smb: \> get flag.txt
getting file \flag.txt of size 37 as flag.txt (12.0 KiloBytes/sec) (average 12.0 KiloBytes/sec)
smb: \> exit
leonuddaniella-academy@webshell:~$ cat flag.txt
picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_51f37693}
```

Step 5

Finally, I copied the flag from the terminal and pasted it into the submission box. The flag was accepted as correct, confirming that I had completed the Printer Shares challenge.

Printer Shares
General Skills Easy
by Janice He · picoCTF 2026

2 [Reveal hint](#)

FLAG ⓘ

Submit

Correct flag!

5. Flag

```
picoCTF{5mb_pr1nter_5h4re5_51f37693}
```

6. Key Concept / What I Learned

In 2-4 sentences, name the underlying security concept or vulnerability class this challenge taught (e.g. "weak RSA exponent," "reflected XSS," "stack buffer overflow"). This is the part of the write-up most worth remembering after the flag is submitted.

This challenge taught me how misconfigured or publicly accessible SMB (Server Message Block) shares can expose files to unauthorized users. I learned how to use smbclient to list available shared directories, connect to a share using guest access, and download files from a remote SMB server

7. References

List any external resource you consulted beyond course materials (a tool's documentation, a technique explainer, a similar public write-up). It is normal and expected to use references — just cite them.

Samba Documentation (<https://www.samba.org/samba/docs/>)

smbclient Manual (<https://www.samba.org/samba/docs/current/man-html/smbclient.1.html>)

OWASP (<https://owasp.org/>)
